PRACTICAL EXPERIMENT 11

Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

Application: Loan Application and Pre-screening Management

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PROGRAMME
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DEPLOYMENT PATH

DEVELOPMENT
Change form + report

›

STAGE 2.0
Test the release

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PRODUCTION 1.0
Current live version

AIM

To demonstrate the Development-to-Production deployment workflow for a Zoho Creator application using Environments, adapting the Hotel Booking example to the existing Loan Application and Pre-screening Management application.

Verified checkpoint at the time of preparing this record: the application has been added to Environments; the change set was published to Stage; Stage shows Version 2.0 and Production remains at Version 1.0. The final Production release is documented as the next step and is not claimed as completed.

Visuals in this record are reconstructed illustrations based on the screen details and Stage record values provided by the student; they are not direct screenshots captured from the Zoho Creator account.

01 / BACKGROUND

Aim, application and environment model

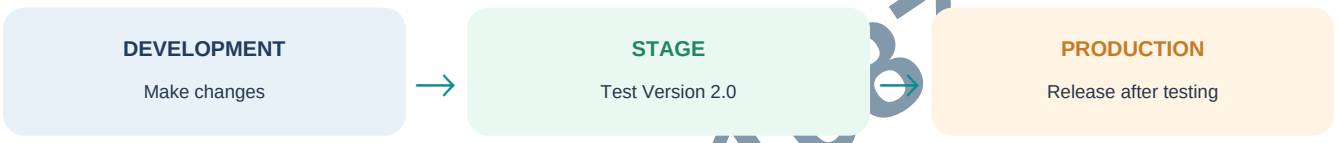
Introduction. Applications used by real users should not be changed directly while those users depend on them. Zoho Creator Environments separates application development, testing, and live use so proposed changes can be checked before release.

Application used. *Loan Application and Pre-screening Management*, an app containing the **Loan_Application_Form**, **Loan_Application_Form Report**, and the **Existing_Liabilities_Details** subform. The practical change for this experiment is a new alternate phone field and a report update.

Environment	Purpose in this experiment
Development	Create and save changes to the form and report.
Stage	Test the new field, a submitted sample record, and the modified report before release.
Production	The live environment. It remains on Version 1.0 until the Stage-tested change is explicitly published.

Why Environments? The separation supports safer testing, controlled releases, traceability through version history, reduced release risk, and clearer roles for developers, testers, and end users.

Deployment workflow



Important status note: Stage 2.0 and Production 1.0 is the correct intermediate checkpoint after the Stage deployment. It is not yet proof that Production has been updated.

02 / PROCEDURE

Prepare the Development changes

Step 1 - Open the application. In Zoho Creator, open the existing application and navigate to **Deploy** → **Environments**. After adding the application to Environments, verify that Stage and Production initially show the baseline Version 1.0.

Step 2 - Modify the loan form. Open the Development copy in the form builder. Add an optional Phone field within the new section **Additional Contact Details**. In this implementation, the field is named **Alternate_Phone_no**; the report should use that same field name.

Step 3 - Modify the report. Open **Loan_Application_Form Report** in Development and configure the report fields so that **Alternate_Phone_no** is included. Save the form/report changes. The label is intentionally recorded as Alternate_Phone_no because that is how the field was configured in the student application.

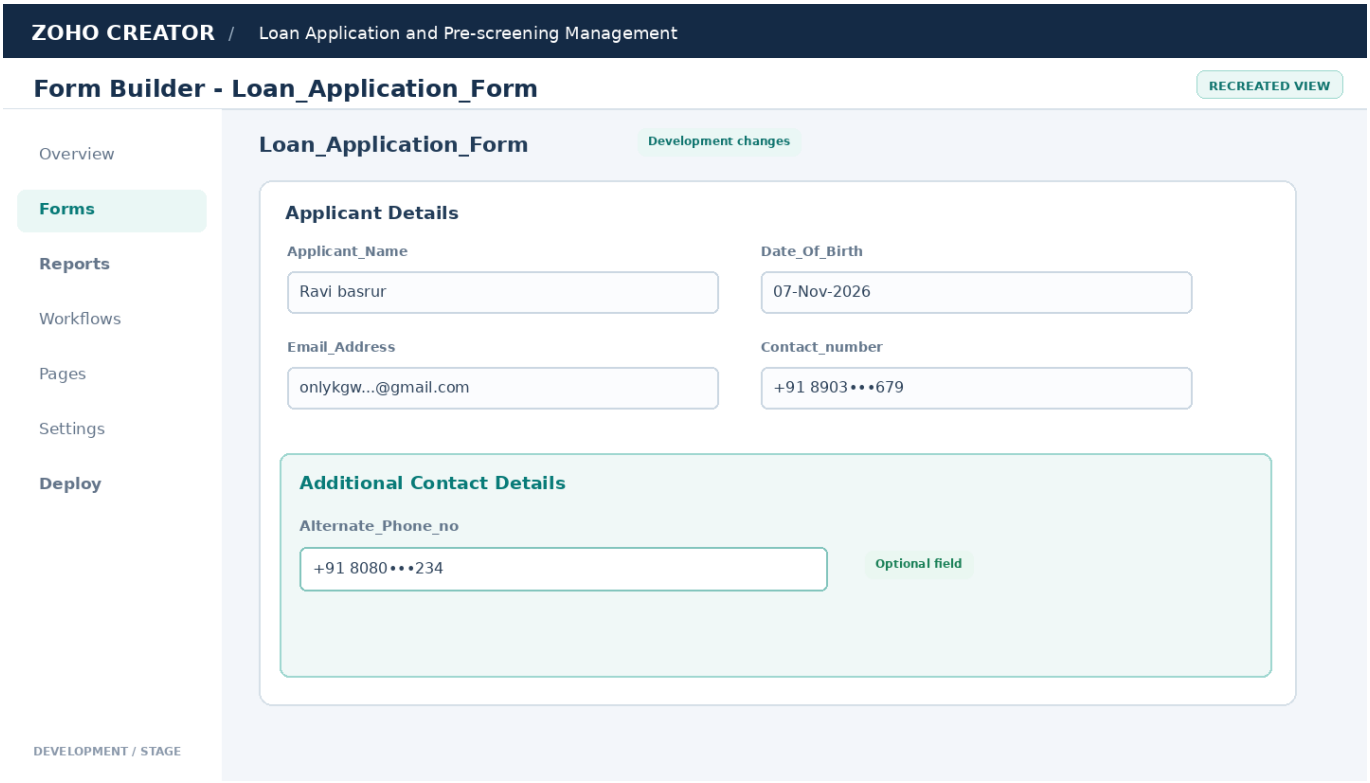


Figure 1. Reconstructed Development form view. The visual shows the new section and the field name used in the actual app; sensitive contact values are masked in this report copy.

Pre-publish check: the form must contain the actual Phone field, not only a section header. Save the form and confirm the new field can be selected in the report before proceeding.

03 / PROCEDURE

Select the changed components and publish to Stage

Step 4 - Start the Stage publish. From Deploy → Environments, choose Publish and select the Stage target. In the component-selection screen, keep the scope limited to the application changes used in this experiment.

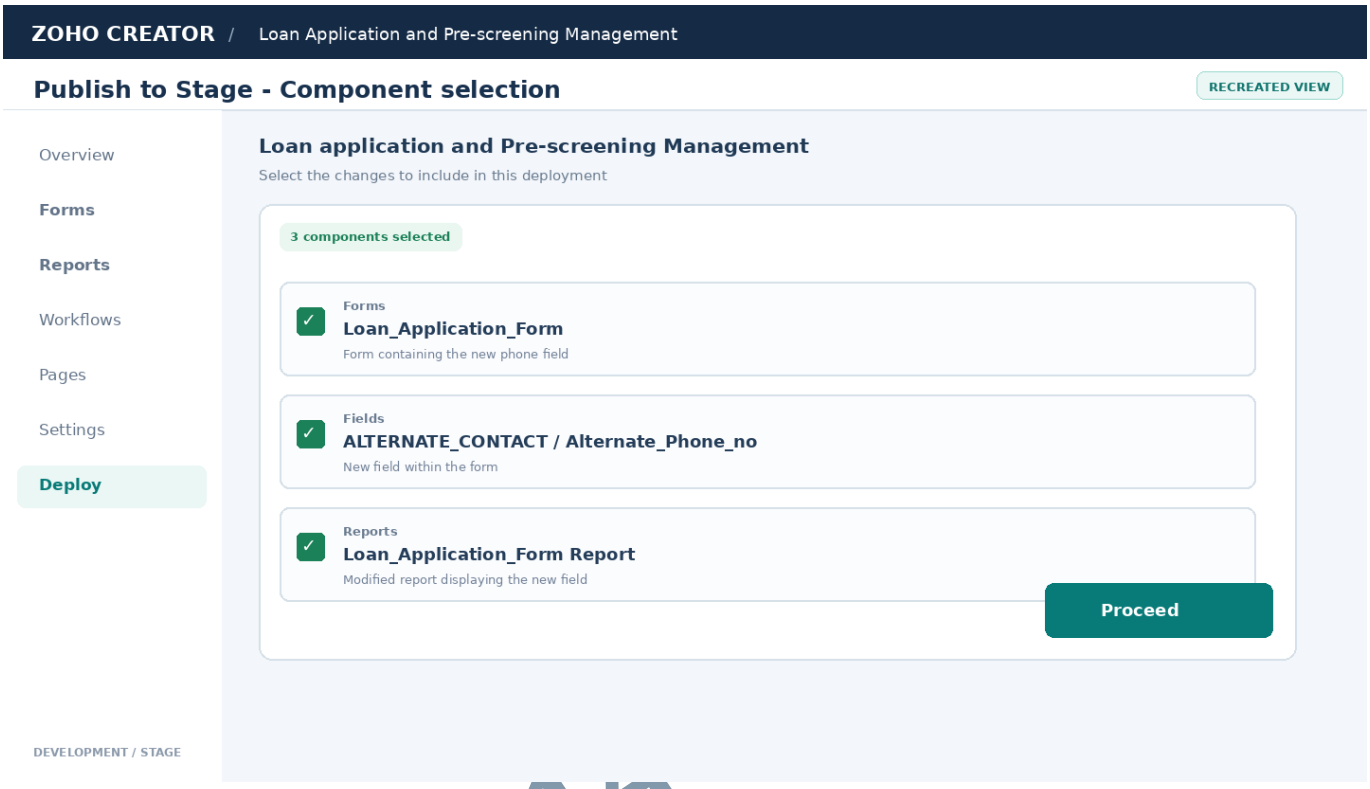


Figure 2. Reconstructed component selection based on the names and count shown in the Stage publish screen.

Selected component	Reason for selection
Forms - Loan_Application_Form	Contains the new alternate phone field.
Fields - ALTERNATE_CONTACT / Alternate_Phone_no	The newly added field, shown separately by the publish wizard.
Reports - Loan_Application_Form Report	The existing report was modified to display the field.

Selected Components: 3. The wizard shows the form, its new field, and the modified report as three components. Do not use Select All when unrelated changes are not part of the experiment.

Version detail	Value used
Version title	Version 2.0
Description	Enhanced loan application with alternate phone field
Type	Major (enhancement/update)
Target	Stage

04 / CHECKPOINT

Verify Stage 2.0 and Production 1.0

Step 5 - Publish to Stage. Proceed with the selected components, enter the version details, and publish. The student reported that the publish completed and the Environments page showed Stage Version 2.0 while Production remained on Version 1.0.

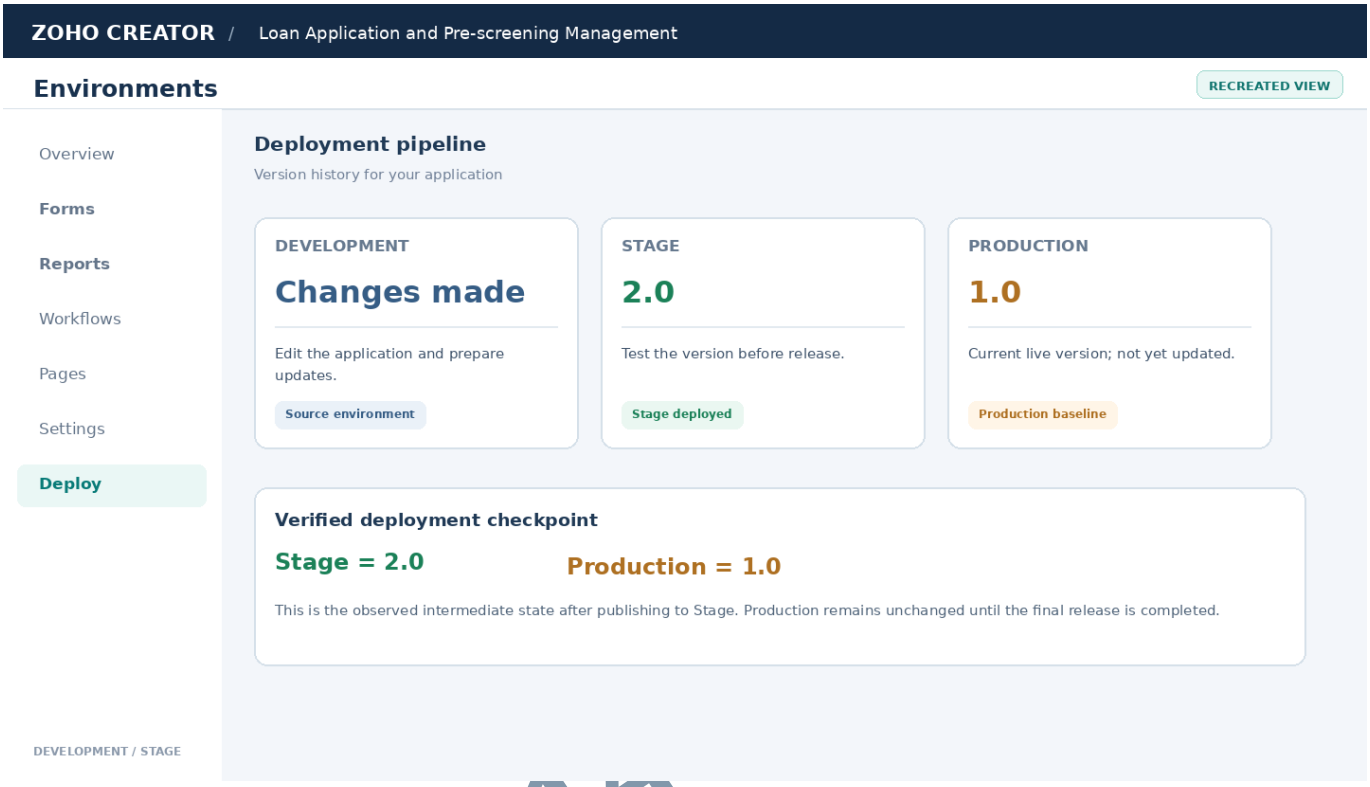


Figure 3. Reconstructed Environments checkpoint showing the observed version split: Stage 2.0 and Production 1.0.

Checkpoint	Stage version	Production version	Interpretation
Baseline before the change	1.0	1.0	Initial application baseline.
After Stage publish (observed)	2.0	1.0	New version is available for Stage testing; live Production is unchanged.
After Production publish (expected later)	2.0	2.0	Final state after the separately confirmed Production release.

Do not skip testing. The Stage publish is only the intermediate deployment step. Test the field and report in Stage before publishing the same release to Production.

05 / VERIFICATION

Submit a test record in Stage

Step 6 - Test the Stage application. Open the Stage access link and submit a sample loan application. The student confirmed that the record submitted and shared the saved record values. The screenshot below is a reconstructed view of those values for the lab record, not a direct screen capture.



Figure 4. Reconstructed Stage record view using the supplied sample values. PAN, email, and phone numbers are masked in this report copy for privacy.

Key values used to verify the new feature

Field	Stage record value / observation
Applicant_Name	Ravi basrur
Loan_Type	Personal Loan
Alternate_Phone_no	A phone number was entered and saved; the configured field name is retained.
Purpose_Sentiment / Purpose_Keywords	Neutral / prashanth neel, directors, music
verified_location	Bangalore, Karnataka

Data note: This is a student-supplied test record. If any values belong to a real person, keep the masked version in documents submitted beyond your own workspace.

06 / REPORT VERIFICATION

Confirm the modified report, then prepare Production

Step 7 - Verify the report in Stage. Open **Loan_Application_Form Report**, locate the test record and confirm that the alternate phone field appears. The student confirmed that it appears as **Alternate_Phone_no**, matching the field name configured in the section.

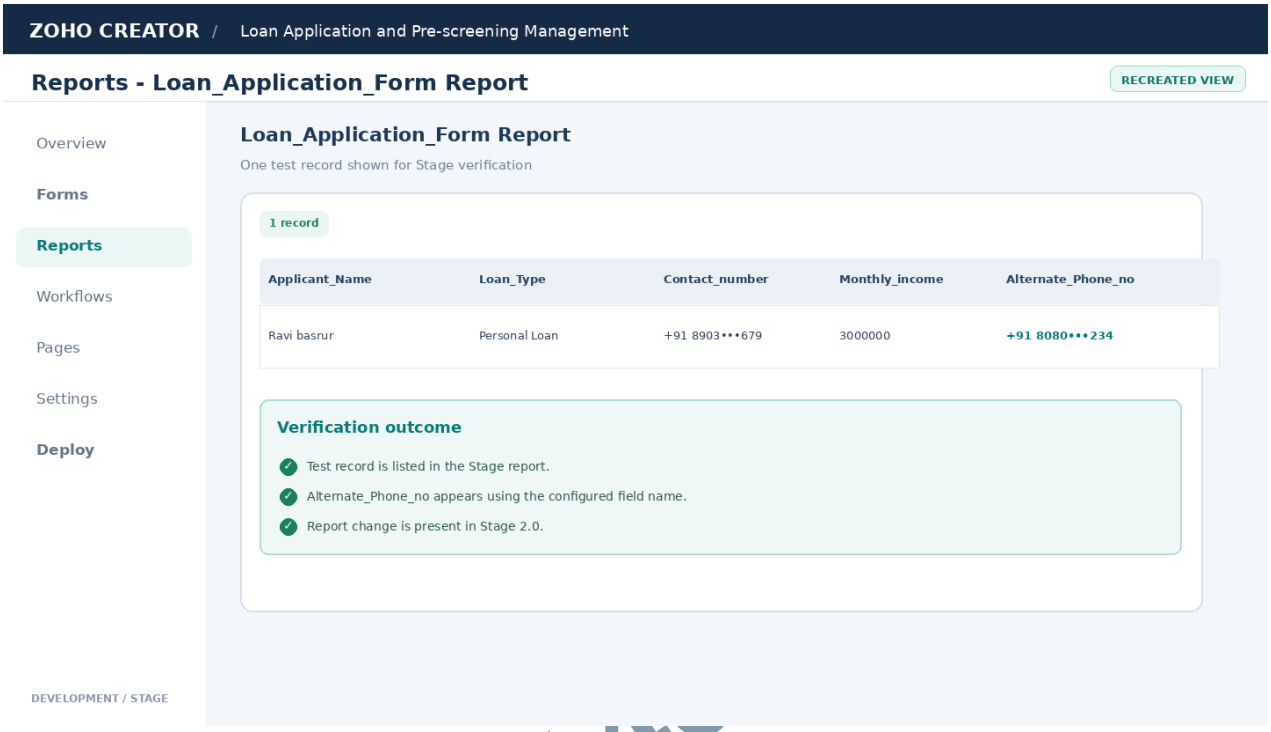


Figure 5. Reconstructed Stage report view, with Alternate_Phone_no shown as the configured field name.

Stage check	Expected / reported outcome	Status
Form submission	Record submitted successfully in Stage.	Passed
Alternate phone field	Alternate_Phone_no appears with the submitted value.	Reported visible
Report update	Modified Loan_Application_Form Report includes the field.	Reported visible
Existing fields and report behaviour	No unrelated behaviour should be broken.	Verify as part of final check

Next action - Production has not been updated yet. When all Stage checks pass, return to Deploy → Environments and choose Publish → Production. The following is a procedure illustration, not evidence that the Production publish has already happened.

07 / PRODUCTION RELEASE

Publish only after successful Stage testing

Step 8 - Publish to Production (pending). In Environments, choose Publish → Production. Select Publish Now (or schedule a later release if required), enter the version details and notification email, review the summary for Version 2.0, and confirm the maintenance-mode warning. Proceed only after your Stage checks are complete and the app owner approves the release.

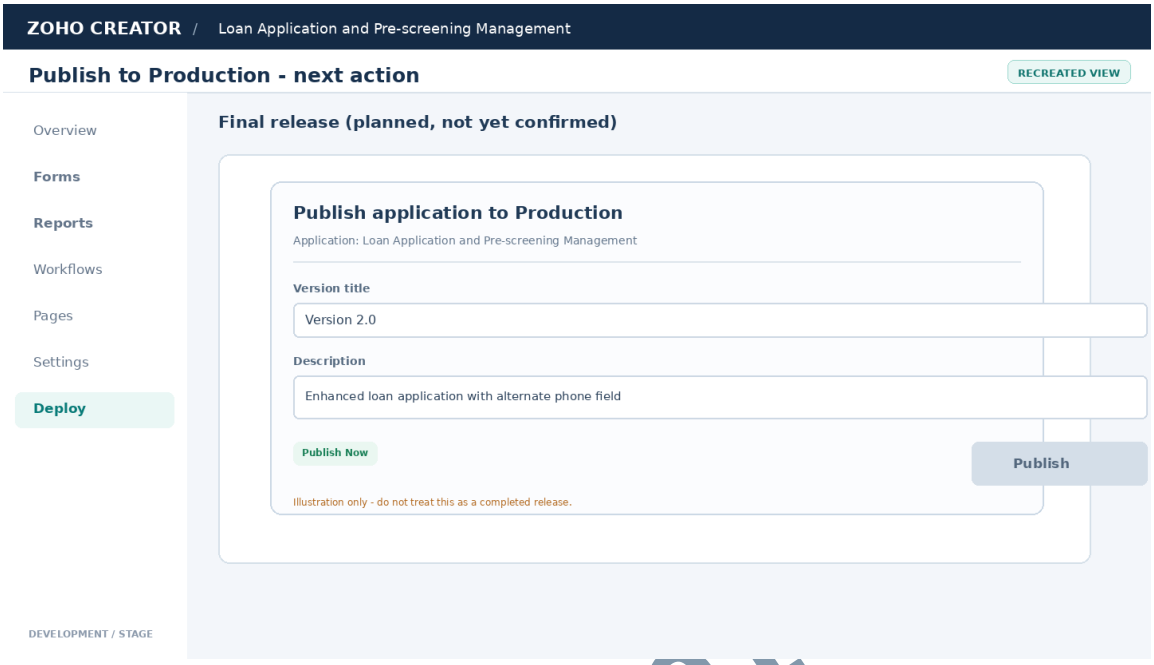


Figure 6. Conceptual Production publish dialogue showing the fields to verify; this is not a captured Zoho Creator screen and the publish is still pending.

Item	Observed / required status
Application added to Environments	Completed
Stage deployment	Version 2.0 published
Stage test record	Submitted successfully
Report field	Alternate_Phone_no reported visible
Production deployment	Pending at the time this document was prepared
Expected final state after Production publish	Stage 2.0 / Production 2.0 / no changes available

Current result. The Loan Application and Pre-screening Management application was added to Environments, the Version 2.0 changes were published to Stage, and a test record was submitted. The new field is recorded as Alternate_Phone_no in line with the configured field name. Production still showed Version 1.0 at the last confirmed checkpoint; complete and verify the Production release before stating that the full Development-to-Production deployment is complete.

> **Final verification after release:** return to Environments and confirm Stage = 2.0, Production = 2.0, and the app indicates no changes available. Update this experiment record with the final confirmed status after completing the publish.